

ENGLISH

GRAMMAR

REPORTED SPEECH

Lecture - 1

Basics

Reporting Verb

REPORTED Speech

Quotation
marks ke
andar ka part

Anushka Said, "I love pancakes."

DIRECT SPEECH

"i can speak
good spanish"

Direct speech has
the actual words of
the speaker. This is
used in writing.

Zen said, "I can
speak good
Spanish."

While writing in direct speech,
inverted commas or speech
marks go before and after the
DIRECT SPEECH

**I can speak
good Spanish**

Punctuation, such as
question marks, full stops
and exclamation marks go
inside the speech marks.

Reported Speech



While writing in indirect speech, inverted commas or speech marks are removed.

Reported speech rephrases and reports the words of the speaker. This is used in speaking and writing.

Reported Speech

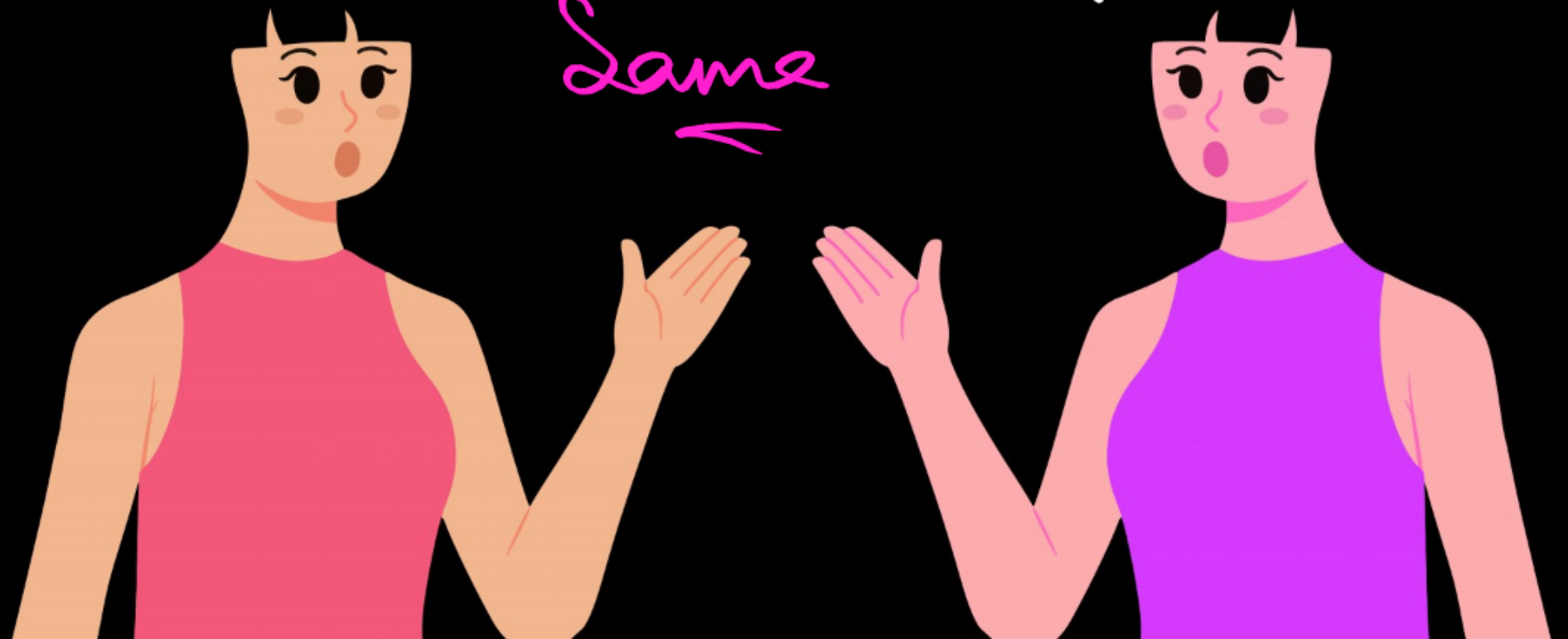
- The word THAT can be used after reporting verbs to begin the statement. But remember- it is optional!

He said that
we won!

He said
we won !

Indirect Speech

Same



Reported Speech

DIRECT

You will keep the verb tense the same in the quotation.

REPORTED

Normally you will change the verb tense when using indirect speech.

Use of Reporting Verb In Statements

We usually introduce reported statements with "reporting verbs" such as "said" or "told":

Example:

- He told me that he had been to Spain.
- She said she had been working hard in the lab.

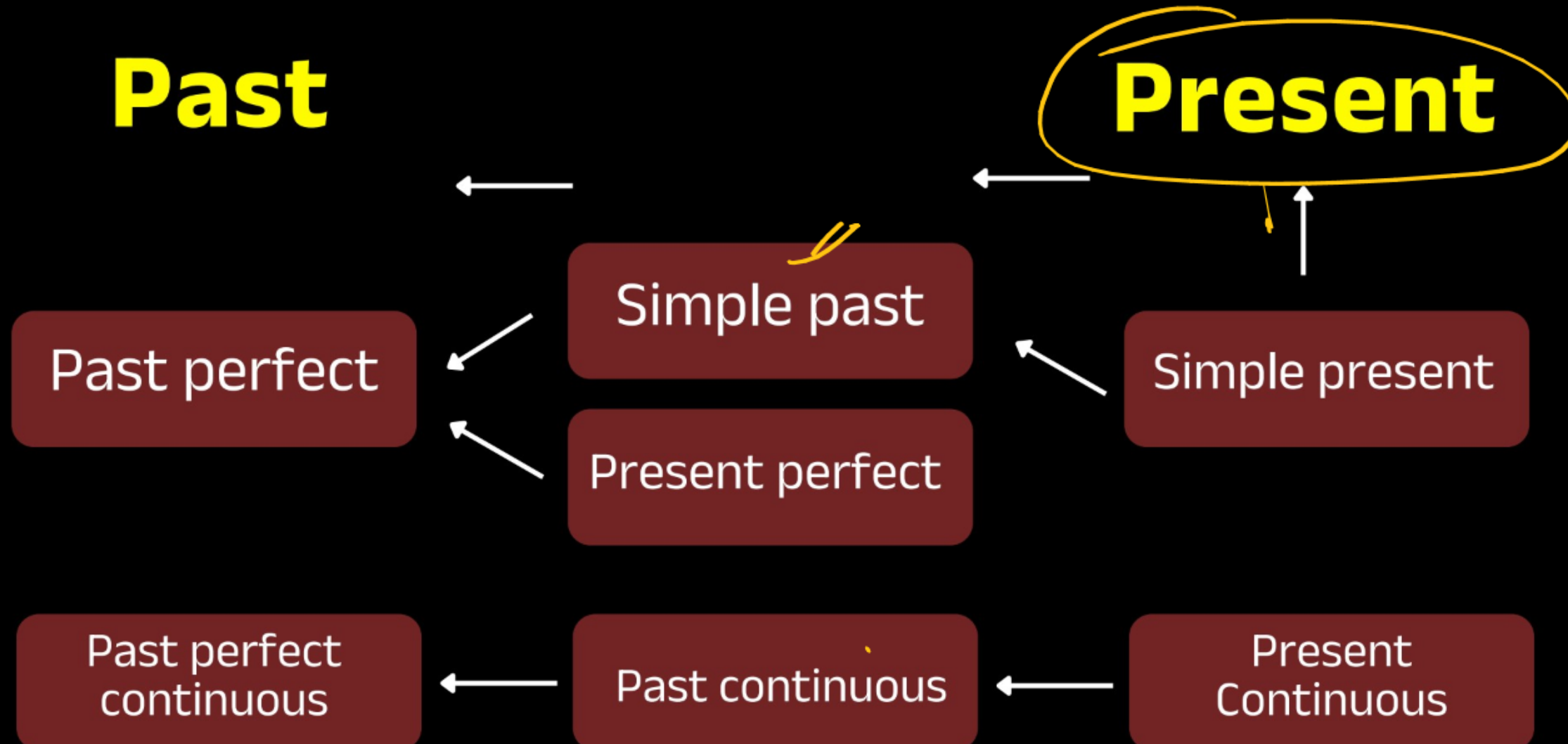
Sentence

Q) Rohan said, "..."
Taniya told, "..."
Brinjal said, "..."

- Typical reporting verbs for statements: say, tell, mention, inform
- He said that...
- He said...
- He told me that...
- He told me...
- He mentioned that...
- He informed me that...

Tenses in Reported speech

In Reported speech, we often use the tense of verb which is 'further back' in the past (e.g. worked) than the tense originally used (e.g. work). This is called 'backshift'.



Tense Change in Reported speech

Direct Speech

Simple Present

✓ He said, "I go to school every day."

Simple Past

He said, "I went to school every day."

Present Perfect

✓ He said, "I have gone to school every day."

Present Continuous

✓ He said, "I am going to school every day."

Past Continuous

He said, "I was going to school every day."

Indirect Speech

Simple Past

He said(that) he went to school every day.

Past Perfect

He said (that) had gone to school every day.

Past Perfect

He said (that) had gone to school every day.

Past Continuous

He said (that) he was going to school every day.

Past Perfect Continuous

He said(that) he had been going to school every day.

Change in time and place expressions

Direct Speech

Now ✓
 Today —
 Tonight
 Yesterday
 Tomorrow
 Last week
 Next year
 This
 Here

Indirect Speech

— Then
 — That day
 That night
 The day before/ The previous day
 The next day/The following day
 The week before
 The following year
 That
 There

Modals often change in reported speech

Direct Speech

- ④
- will
 - can
 - may
 - must

Reported Speech

- would
- could
- might
- had to

- Could, would, should, might and ought to in direct speech DO NOT change in reported speech. Could, would, should, might and ought to in direct speech DO NOT change in reported speech.

Change in Pronouns

Rule 2 Pronouns change according to a rule named SON

S

Subject of the reported speech is in First Person

(I, me, my, us, mine,
myself, ourselves)

It will change according
to the Subject of the
Reporting Verb

He said, "I like cooking"
He said that he likes cooking

O

Subject of the reported
speech is in Second
Person.

(you, your, yours)

It will change according
to the Object of the
Reporting Verb.

Mary said to me, "Can you see
me?"

Mary asked me if I could see her

N

Subject of the reported
speech is in Third Person.

(all except the first
and the second person)

No Change will
take place.

They said, "It is raining"
They said that it was raining

Rule 1 When reporting in direct speech to report, Omit all inverted commas or quotation marks. End the sentence with a full stop.

Direct

He said, "I was really angry with you today."



Indirect

He told me that he had been really angry with me that day.

Rule 3b If the reporting verb is in the present tense, the tenses of the direct speech DO NOT change.

Direct Speech

The child says, "I am feeling cold."

Indirect Speech

The child says that she is feeling cold.

Rule 3h If the verb inside the inverted commas is in the future tense, no changes are made except shall and will are changed into would.

Direct Speech

They said, "We will go to school together."

Becomes

Indirect Speech

They said that they would go to school together.

Rule 4 If the Reported Speech is a universal truth, idiom, a rule, a proverb or a habitual fact the tense remains as it is.

Direct Speech

Mom said, "Where there is a will, there is a way."



Indirect Speech

Mom told us that where there is a will, there is a way.

Some Common Misconceptions in Reported Speech

1. Indirect Speech always includes 'that'.

For example– He asked me where I am going. (Correct) He asked me that where I am going. (Incorrect)

2. Indirect Speech always change its tense to past tense.

For example– Sheen said sun rose in the east. (incorrect) Sheen said sun rises in the east.(correct)

3. In indirect Speech, 'may' always changes to 'might'.

For example– May I come in?, he said. (Direct Speech) He asked if he could come in. (Indirect Speech)

Some Common Misconceptions in Reported Speech

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For example– May I come in?, he said. (Direct Speech) He asked if he could come in. (Indirect Speech)

Steps to Change Questions or Interrogative Sentences

1

Don't use
conjunction
'that'.

X



2

Change
Question mark
into full stop.



3

Change 'Say to'
to 'ask' and
'said to' to
'asked'.



4

Change
Pronouns, tense
and adverb
accordingly.

Use of Reporting Verb in Questions

We usually introduce reported questions with the verb "ask": *asked*

2 types

- He asked (me) if/whether... (YES/NO questions) *Short / MCQ / one word*
- He asked (me) why/when/where/what/how... (question-word questions) *- Explain.*

Example:

He asked whether I wanted tea or coffee.

Teacher asked me why I was late.

Use of Reporting Verb in Questions

- If the question starts with a auxiliary verb in direct speech it takes if/whether in indirect speech.
- There is change in pronouns and tense (backshift).

Aunty
said,

"Do you
like eating
pasta?"

"Have you
washed your
hands?"

if/

Aunty asked
whether I liked
eating pasta.

She asked if I
had washed
my hands.

Use of Reporting Verb in Questions

- If the question starts with a Wh-word in direct speech, we introduce the reported questions with asked + question word.
- There is change in pronouns and tense (backshift).

Dad said: "Why didn't you say something?"

He said: "When did all these happen?"

Dad asked me why I hadn't said anything.

He asked when all those happened.

Commands and Requests in Reported Speech

- What did the teacher say to the children in the classroom today?

Open your English Grammar book please.

Don't use your cell phone in the classroom!!

Don't chew gum in the classroom, please.

Reported speech:

- The teacher asked us to open our English grammar book.
- The teacher ordered Zen not to use his cell phone in the classroom.
- The teacher requested the students not to chew gum in the classroom.

Commands and Requests in Reported Speech

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Change of Speech in Imperative Sentences

Said
to becomes

'requested' if
there is a sense
of request in
the sentence.

'ordered' if
there is a sense
of order in the
sentence.

- Instead of 'that', TO is used to join the reported speech
- Pronouns, tense and adverb changes accordingly

Reporting Verbs
Tone
↑
informed, asked,
Commanded,

Change of Speech in Imperative Sentences

Show me
your
tongue.

Command
Order

Breathe
deeply.

Open your
mouth, please.

- Let's see what the commands and requests of the doctor look like in indirect speech:
 1. The doctor requested me to open my mouth.
 2. The doctor asked me to breathe deeply.
 3. The doctor ordered me to show her my tongue.

Change of Speech in Imperative Sentences

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Change of Speech in Exclamatory Sentences

When Joy is expressed
with the words like
'Hurrah', 'Aha' 'Yay, etc,



Change the reporting verb
into 'Exclaimed with joy' or
'Exclaimed with delight.'

Direct Speech

Rahul said, "Hurrah! I got
the match tickets."

Indirect Speech

Rahul exclaimed with joy
that he had got the match
tickets.

Change of Speech in Exclamatory Sentences

When Sorrow is
expressed with
the words Alas etc.



Change the reporting verb
into Exclaimed with sorrow
or Exclaimed with grief.

Direct Speech

Richa said, "Alas! I couldn't qualify the exam."

Indirect Speech

Richa exclaimed with sorrow that she couldn't qualify the exam.

Change of Speech in Exclamatory Sentences

If there is an Adjective after What and How, change it with Very.

Direct Speech

Tina said, "How beautiful is the view from my window!"

Indirect Speech

Tina exclaimed that the view from her window was very beautiful.

Change of Speech in Exclamatory Sentences

If there is a Noun after 'What' and 'How' in the sentence, change it with 'Great'.

Direct Speech

Neelu said, "What a fool I am!"
monkey.

Indirect Speech

Neelu exclaimed that she
was a great fool.

Change of Speech in Exclamatory Sentences

If the verb inside the inverted commas is in the future tense, no changes are made except shall and will are changed into would.

If the reporting verb is in the present tense, the tenses of the direct speech DO NOT change.

If the verb inside the inverted commas is in present tense, change it into the corresponding past tense.

If the verb inside the inverted commas is in the past continuous tense, change it into the corresponding past perfect continuous tense.

Conversion Direct to **Reported speech**

If the Reported Speech is a universal truth, idiom, a rule, a proverb or a habitual fact the tense remains as it is.

If the verb inside the inverted commas is in the past tense /present perfect tense, change it into the corresponding past perfect tense.

If the verb inside the inverted commas is in the present continuous tense, change it into the corresponding past continuous tense.

Change of Speech in Exclamatory Sentences

When Sorrow is expressed with the words Alas etc. Change the reporting verb into Exclaimed with sorrow or Exclaimed with

Reported questions do not end with a question mark.

If the question starts with a auxiliary verb in direct speech, it takes if/whether in reported speech.

Conversion Direct to **Reported speech**

When Joy is expressed with the words like 'Hurrah', 'Aha' 'Yay, etc, Change the reporting verb into 'Exclaimed with joy' or 'Exclaimed with delight.'

To introduce reporting commands or requests we use a reporting verb like request, order etc.

If the question starts with a Wh-word, we introduce the reported questions with asked + question word.

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